periodic overtures to President Putin may be straws in the wind.

Towards an India–Russia 4.0

Going forward, India–Russia relations will be influenced by the answers to the questions posed in the foregoing. The leaders of the two countries continue to publicly project their personal chemistry and confirm the strategic content of the relationship. They have actively encouraged a broad-based cooperation architecture to ensure strong mutual stakes in the relationship that would incentivise each partner to be sensitive to the core concerns of the other. They have had extended *tête-à-têtes* on the sidelines of their summits to reconcile divergences. They have periodically articulated their perspectives publicly on convergences and concerns. In June 2016, President Putin told an Indian journalist that the expanding India–US relationship was a "perfectly natural process," but since India–Russia cooperation included some "very sensitive areas," he expected that India would take Russian interests and concerns into account while pursuing relations with other countries.[29] His assurance that Russia would not transfer the same level of military technologies to China as it does to India has already been referred to. At their bilateral press conference in October 2016, Prime Minister Modi reminded President Putin of a Russian proverb: "An old friend is better than two new ones." This was interpreted as meaning that India will not sacrifice the Russia relationship while building a new partnership with the United States. It could just as well have been a message to Russia that it should be sensitive to the benefits from the partnership with India, even while strengthening its ties with China.